

Cyprus

Commission for the Protection of Competition

The eOASIS system was developed by the government through co-financing with the European Union.¹⁶ The eOASIS office automation system is the Government's Official Correspondence and Communication Management System both within the Service itself and between the Services of the various departments of the government. It concerns the electronic filing and management of official documents of government organizations, as well as the automation of the procedures and regulations governing the creation, archiving, security, circulation of documents as well as their final destruction or their long-term preservation and future availability to the public or to researchers through the State Archives. The eOASIS System aims to automate the management of documents (Electronic Document Management) and is web-based in accordance with European and other international standards.

It covers all the requirements of the public sector in relation to document management by providing a comprehensive range of functions. The system supports, among other things, the creation of electronic workflows, which automate predetermined procedures, such as that of filing, and allows remote working, thus serving the operators who need access to documents of their service when they are out of the office.

The online version of e-OASIS has a central infrastructure (eOASIS Cloud) from where it serves all the Government Organizations in which the system currently operates, with the exception of three independent facilities.

By using the eOASIS system, the Services benefit from the following:

- A significant reduction in the time of filing and handling documents;
- Increased document security and controlled access to documents by authorized users;
- Easy and fast retrieval of documents based on search criteria;
- Simultaneous access to the same document/folder by multiple operators;
- Keeping all documents in electronic form and significantly reducing the use of paper;

¹⁶The initials of the system stand for Electronic Office Automation System and Integrated Services.

- Access to the system from remote points and possibility of teleworking from abroad and/or home;
- Maintaining the integrity of the documents (avoid their alteration and/or falsification);
- Avoiding the loss and/or destruction (damage) of physical folders and documents;
- Automatic electronic transfer of important and/or historical documents from an organization to the State Archives for permanent safekeeping and long-term preservation;
- Improvement of communication and cooperation between departments;
- Reduction of the time of sharing documents between departments;
- Increase of productivity, efficiency and effectiveness of the government;
- Containment of the growth rate of specific staff groups, such as secretarial staff, clerks, auxiliary staff (callers), etc.;
- Reduction in the use of the post office, handling of physical envelopes through couriers, storage areas, unnecessary use of paper, faxes, etc.

The most important advantages of the System are:

- The use of a Unified Thematic Classification System, which provides uniform numbering of files throughout the public sector;
- The possibility of simultaneous access to the same document by more than one person;
- The ability to find documents quickly and easily, through various criteria (eg title, date, file number, etc.) as well as through content search through optical character recognition (OCR);
- The ability to access documents from remote locations;
- Ensuring controlled access to the system and increased document security;
- The reduction of paper use;
- Increasing productivity through the immediate availability of documents, information and instructions;
- The reduction of document filing time.

The System, at the present stage, operates in each department/service independently, however it provides the possibility of inter-departmental connection (*i.e.*, electronic sending of documents between Departments/Services through the System) which is piloted in 4 Departments (Deputy Ministry of Research, Innovation and Digital Policy, IT Services Department, Public Administration and Personnel Department).

The System is currently in operation in 49 Organizations (Ministries/Deputy Ministries/ Departments/Services) of the public sector. The implementation of the eOASIS System is expected to be completed throughout the public sector by the end of 2026. It is noted that the Office Automation System, eOASIS is operational in various organizations of the wider Public Sector, such as the University of Cyprus, the Research Promotion Foundation and the Cyprus Energy Regulatory Authority.

The system was introduced for the electronic management and filing of documents, and it is further developed by the central government. It is a system applied in the public service of the Republic of Cyprus and it was introduced in our offices in December 2020. The CPC notified all interested parties regarding the introduction of this system through a press release calling for the filing of documents in a digital format.¹⁷

More information (in Greek) can be found on the Commission's webpage.¹⁸

¹⁷ Commission for the Protection of Competition, <http://www.competition.gov.cy/competition/competition.nsf/All/26B46D540F515708C2258634004545FE?OpenDocument&highlight=e-oasis> (last accessed June 7, 2023).

¹⁸ Commission for the Protection of Competition, <https://dits.dmrid.gov.cy/dmrid/DITS/dits.nsf/All/46D813D43EFFDA97C2258565003A4B73?OpenDocument> (last accessed June 7, 2023).